

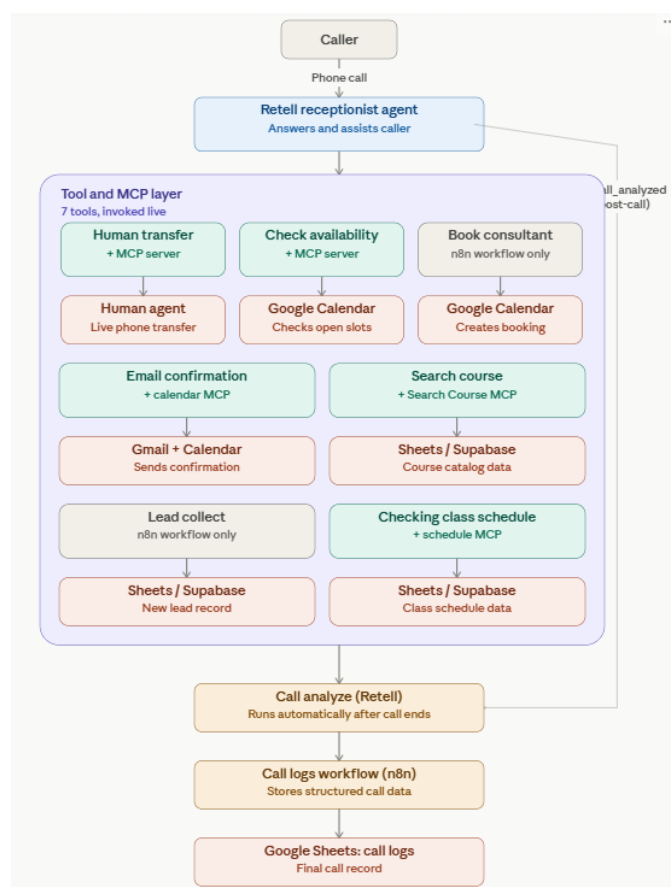
AI Voice Receptionist

Retell AI voice agent · n8n automation backend · Google Sheets live database

Ostad Academy's AI voice receptionist answers real phone calls, entirely by voice and in English. Built on Retell AI for the conversational voice agent, n8n for workflow automation, and Google Sheets as the live database, it searches courses, checks class schedules, books consultations, captures leads, sends SMS and confirmation emails, and escalates to a human when needed.

Architecture

The diagram below shows the full call flow: from the caller reaching the Retell agent, through the tool and MCP layer that talks to n8n, to the backend systems each tool writes to, and the automatic post-call logging path.



Flow summary

1. A caller dials the Retell phone number and talks to the Ostad receptionist, the voice agent.
2. The receptionist calls one of 8 Custom Function tools over HTTP whenever it needs real data or needs to take an action — it never invents course names, fees, or dates.
3. Each tool is a webhook into n8n, which runs a dedicated workflow, reads and writes Google Sheets through MCP, and returns a spoken-friendly summary back to Retell.
4. After every call ends, Retell fires a separate post-call webhook with the full transcript and its own sentiment and intent analysis, which n8n logs to the Call Logs tab automatically.

Tools (Retell Custom Functions)

All 8 tools are implemented as n8n webhook nodes in one workflow, “Ostad AI Receptionist – Custom Function Webhooks v2.” Each webhook calls a dedicated sub-workflow that owns the actual business logic and Google Sheets read/write. Every response is returned as { "spoken_summary": "...", "success": true|false }, so the agent's prompt can read a consistent, predictable field name.

Function	Purpose	Key inputs
Search_Courses	Looks up course name, fee, duration, and batch date	Course name
Class_Schedule	Gets the class schedule for a main class or a support class	Class type (main or support)
Check_availability	Checks whether a time slot is available for booking a consultant	Time, date
Book_Consultation	Creates a booking with a consultant in an available slot	Name, phone, email, problem, time, date
Lead_info	Collects a caller's lead details	Name, phone, email, topic
Human_Transfer	Escalates the call when the client wants a human agent or has a critical issue	Problem, email, phone, name
Email_confirmation	Sends the caller a confirmation email	Name, phone, email
send_sms	Sends an SMS, for example with the office address, when the caller asks	Phone

Bonus features

- Email confirmation — every successful booking sends a confirmation email via Gmail with the caller's name, phone, date, and time.
- Google Calendar integration — every successful booking creates a real event on the Ostad Consultations calendar, as a 1-hour slot in the correct timezone.
- SMS notifications — sends a real-time SMS with the office address when a caller asks to visit.

Conversation logging

A separate n8n workflow listens on Retell's Agent Webhook URL for the call_analyzed event, which fires once per call after Retell's own analysis completes. It logs the following to the CallLogs tab:

- Call ID, caller number, timestamp, and duration
- Intent, from a custom post-call analysis field
- Sentiment, from Retell's built-in analysis
- Full transcript and summary

Data store — Google Sheets

One spreadsheet, five tabs, acting as the live database:

Tab	Columns
Courses	CourseName, Category, Duration, Fee, BatchStart, Schedule
Appointments	Name, Phone, Email, Date, Time, Status
Leads	Name, Phone, Email, InterestedCourse

Tab	Columns
Escalations	Name, Phone, Reason
CallLogs	Timestamp, CallerNumber, DurationSeconds, Duration, Intent, Sentiment, Summary, Transcript